and charged her with interference. The DCP (South), Balwant Singh, Bhinder told her, had already submitted his report to him and he had, as a matter of fact, even commended him for his brilliant work over so short a period of time. According to the South District Police, the case had been solved within 24 hours. The claim of the South District Police did not prove reliable, and the accused did get the benefit of Kiran's investigations, but after the loss of his wife, his child and his own liberty for some time.

The accused person's wife, who was near delivery time, could not bear the trauma of her husband's arrest and died of shock. The media, which had heard of Kiran's investigations, took up the human interest angle of the story and conducted its own investigations. The incompetence of the South District Police was exposed and the accused person was released. But some of her seniors and a few of her colleagues did not forgive her on this count. Was it envy or was it for the right reasons? Kiran seemed to have no patience to figure out the answer to this question as she was always totally focused on the larger good …

Maybe it is this attitude of compassion that Mother Teresa discerned in Kiran. During her tenure as IG (Prisons), the Mother called her up and expressed her desire to meet her. Kiran called on her at her ashram and got a couple of hugs from her. When Kiran was leaving and was almost near the gate, she heard the Mother asking her to wait. She turned round to see this frail and petite person come running towards her, bare feet, and give her a third big hug. To Kiran's round-eyed look she merely told her that she had got this urge to just hug her once more. Perhaps the Mother felt that Kiran needed to be protected with her blessings.

And protected Kiran is …